

GroveLEDBarPWM — Full API Reference

Version: 1.8.0

Hardware: Seeed Grove LED Bar V2.1 / MY9221

Target: Arduino-compatible boards, including ESP32-C3

1. Overview

GroveLEDBarPWM provides PWM brightness control for all ten LEDs on the Grove LED Bar V2.1. It also provides:

- Individual LED brightness
- Brightness arrays
- Graduated brightness
- Green-to-red logical ordering
- Smooth non-blocking transitions
- Individual LED flashing
- Moving Dot effect
- Knight Rider effect
- Pulse/Breathe effect
- Configurable data and clock pins

The library is designed around a non-blocking `update()` function, allowing the LED bar animation to run while the main application continues to handle sensors, MQTT, LoRa, Wi-Fi, and other tasks.

2. Installation

Copy the GroveLEDBarPWM library into your Arduino libraries directory.

Then include:

```
#include <GroveLEDBarPWM.h>
```

3. Hardware and Pins

The constructor accepts the DATA and CLOCK GPIO pins:

```
GroveLEDBarPWM bar(DATA_PIN, CLOCK_PIN);
```

Example:

```
GroveLEDBarPWM bar(20, 21);
```

The pin numbers are not fixed by the library.

For example:

```
GroveLEDBarPWM bar(7, 6);
```

is also valid when those GPIOs are connected correctly.

4. Grove LED Bar Channel Mapping

The MY9221 channel order is different from the logical LED order used by the library.

The physical channel mapping is:

MY9221 Channel	LED colour
0	Red
1	Yellow
2	Green
3	Green
4	Green
5	Green
6	Green
7	Green
8	Green
9	Green

When green-to-red ordering is enabled, the library presents the bar logically from green to red.

Logical LED numbers are **zero based**:

LED 0 = first logical LED

LED 9 = last logical LED

5. Constructor

`GroveLEDBarPWM()`

Syntax

```
GroveLEDBarPWM(uint8_t dataPin, uint8_t clockPin);
```

Example

```
GroveLEDBarPWM bar(20, 21);
```

Creates an LED bar object using GPIO 20 for DATA and GPIO 21 for CLOCK.

6. Initialisation

begin()

Initialises the DATA and CLOCK pins and clears the LED bar.

Syntax

```
bar.begin();
```

Call this from `setup()`.

7. Pin Configuration

setPins()

Changes the DATA and CLOCK GPIO pins.

```
bar.setPins(dataPin, clockPin);
```

Example:

```
bar.setPins(7, 6);
```

getDataPin()

Returns the currently configured DATA GPIO.

```
uint8_t pin = bar.getDataPin();
```

getClockPin()

Returns the currently configured CLOCK GPIO.

```
uint8_t pin = bar.getClockPin();
```

8. Basic Bar Control

setLevel()

Sets the number of logical LEDs that should be illuminated.

```
bar.setLevel(level);
```

Example:

```
bar.setLevel(5);
```

With transitions disabled, the requested level is applied immediately.

With transitions enabled, the bar moves smoothly toward the requested level.

Valid range:

0 to 10

clear()

Turns all LEDs off and stops the current effect.

```
bar.clear();
```

show()

Sends the current brightness frame to the LED bar.

```
bar.show();
```

9. Individual LED Brightness

setBrightness()

Sets an individual LED's PWM value.

```
bar.setBrightness(index, brightness);
```

Brightness range:

0 to 255

Example:

```
bar.setBrightness(5, 128);
```

sets logical LED 5 to approximately 50% PWM.

setBrightnessPercent()

Sets an individual LED using a percentage.

```
bar.setBrightnessPercent(index, percent);
```

Example:

```
bar.setBrightnessPercent(5, 50);
```

getBrightness()

Returns the current PWM brightness of a logical LED.

```
uint8_t value = bar.getBrightness(5);
```

Returns:

0 to 255

getBrightnessPercent()

Returns the current brightness as a percentage.

```
uint8_t value = bar.getBrightnessPercent(5);
```

10. Brightness Arrays

setBrightnessArray()

Sets all ten LEDs using percentages.

```
uint8_t brightness[10] = {  
    10, 20, 30, 40, 50,  
    60, 70, 80, 90, 100  
};
```

```
bar.setBrightnessArray(brightness);
```

Each value is:

0 to 100 percent

getBrightnessArray()

Returns the current brightness of all ten LEDs as percentages.

```
uint8_t brightness[10];
```

```
bar.getBrightnessArray(brightness);
```

setBrightnessArrayPWM()

Sets all ten LEDs directly using PWM values.

```
uint8_t brightness[10] = {  
    25, 50, 75, 100, 125,  
    150, 175, 200, 225, 255  
};
```

```
bar.setBrightnessArrayPWM(brightness);
```

Values range from:

0 to 255

getBrightnessArrayPWM()

Returns all ten LED brightness values as PWM values.

```
uint8_t brightness[10];
```

```
bar.getBrightnessArrayPWM(brightness);
```

setAllBrightness()

Sets all ten LEDs to the same PWM value.

```
bar.setAllBrightness(128);
```

11. Graduated Brightness

setGraduated()

Enables or disables graduated brightness when using levels and transitions.

```
bar.setGraduated(true);
```

Disable:

```
bar.setGraduated(false);
```

The graduated curve used by the library is:

```
5% → 10% → 20% → 30% → 40%  
→ 50% → 60% → 70% → 80% → 100%
```

getGraduated()

Returns whether graduated brightness is enabled.

```
bool enabled = bar.getGraduated();
```

setGraduationMin()

Sets the minimum graduation percentage.

```
bar.setGraduationMin(5);
```

The value is constrained to 0–100%.

getGraduationMin()

Returns the configured graduation minimum.

```
uint8_t value = bar.getGraduationMin();
```

12. Green-to-Red Direction

setGreenToRed()

Controls the logical direction of the bar.

```
bar.setGreenToRed(true);
```

With this enabled, logical LED numbering follows the intended green-to-red display direction.

Disable it with:

```
bar.setGreenToRed(false);
```

getGreenToRed()

Returns the current direction setting.

```
bool enabled = bar.getGreenToRed();
```

13. Smooth Transitions

Transitions are non-blocking.

setTransition()

Enable or disable smooth level transitions.

```
bar.setTransition(true);
```

Disable:

```
bar.setTransition(false);
```

getTransition()

Returns whether transitions are enabled.

```
bool enabled = bar.getTransition();
```

setTransitionSpeed()

Sets the transition speed.

```
bar.setTransitionSpeed(10);
```

Higher values produce faster brightness changes.

getTransitionSpeed()

Returns the transition speed.

```
uint8_t speed = bar.getTransitionSpeed();
```

setTransitionTime()

Sets the approximate transition time.

```
bar.setTransitionTime(500);
```

The value is in milliseconds.

getTransitionTime()

Returns the configured transition time.

```
uint16_t time = bar.getTransitionTime();
```

isTransitioning()

Returns true while the bar is still moving toward its requested level.

```
if (bar.isTransitioning()) {  
    // Transition still running  
}
```

14. Flashing an Individual LED

setFlashSpeed()

Sets the flash timing.

```
bar.setFlashSpeed(500);
```

The value is in milliseconds.

getFlashSpeed()

Returns the configured flash speed.

```
uint16_t speed = bar.getFlashSpeed();
```

flashLED()

Starts a flash on one logical LED.

```
bar.flashLED(5);
```

The LED rises from its current brightness to full brightness and then returns toward the current underlying brightness.

The flash is non-blocking.

isFlashing()

Returns `true` while an LED flash is active.

```
if (bar.isFlashing()) {  
    // Flash is active  
}
```

15. Effects

Effects are controlled using the `Effect` enumeration.

Available effects in V1.8.0:

```
GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_NONE  
GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_MOVING_DOT  
GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_KNIGHT_RIDER  
GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_PULSE
```

setEffectSpeed()

Sets the effect speed.

```
bar.setEffectSpeed(150);
```

The value is in milliseconds between effect updates.

getEffectSpeed()

Returns the configured effect speed.

```
uint16_t speed = bar.getEffectSpeed();
```

startEffect()

Starts an effect.

Moving Dot

```
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_MOVING_DOT);
```

The dot travels:

LED 0 → LED 9 → LED 0

Knight Rider

```
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_KNIGHT_RIDER);
```

The centre LED is brightest with graduated neighbouring LEDs.

Pulse/Breathe

```
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_PULSE);
```

All ten LEDs smoothly brighten and dim together.

stopEffect()

Stops the current effect.

```
bar.stopEffect();
```

The underlying bar brightness is restored.

isEffectRunning()

Returns `true` when an effect is active.

```
if (bar.isEffectRunning()) {  
    // Effect running  
}
```

16. Pulse/Breathe

setPulseRange()

Sets the minimum and maximum brightness of the Pulse/Breathe effect.

```
bar.setPulseRange(minimumPercent, maximumPercent);
```

Example:

```
bar.setPulseRange(10, 80);
```

This produces:

10% → 80% → 10% → 80% ...

Values are constrained to 0–100%.

getPulseMinimum()

Returns the configured minimum percentage.

```
uint8_t minimum = bar.getPulseMinimum();
```

getPulseMaximum()

Returns the configured maximum percentage.

```
uint8_t maximum = bar.getPulseMaximum();
```

17. The update() Function

update()

This is the main function for all non-blocking transitions, flashes and effects.

```
bar.update();
```

It should normally be called repeatedly from `loop()`.

Example:

```
void loop()
{
    bar.update();

    // Other application code can run here.
}
```

Do not replace `update()` with a long `delay()` if you want the effect to remain smooth and responsive.

18. Complete Example

The following example demonstrates a typical application:

```

#include <GroveLEDBarPWM.h>

GroveLEDBarPWM bar(20, 21);

void setup()
{
    bar.begin();

    bar.setGreenToRed(true);
    bar.setGraduated(true);

    bar.setTransitionTime(500);
    bar.setLevel(5);
}

void loop()
{
    bar.update();

    // Other application code can run here.
}

```

19. Process Indicator Example

A useful application is to use Moving Dot while a process is running:

```

bar.setEffectSpeed(150);
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_MOVING_DOT);

while (processRunning) {
    bar.update();

    // Process code...
}

```

```
bar.stopEffect();
```

For a Knight Rider process indicator:

```

bar.setEffectSpeed(100);
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_KNIGHT_RIDER);

```

For an idle/waiting indicator:

```

bar.setPulseRange(10, 60);
bar.setEffectSpeed(20);

```

```
bar.startEffect(GroveLEDBarPWM::EFFECT_PULSE);
```

20. Non-Blocking Design

The library's transitions, flashing and effects are designed to be non-blocking.

The recommended pattern is:

```
void loop()
{
    bar.update();

    readSensors();
    handleMQTT();
    handleLoRa();
    checkButtons();
}
```

This allows the LED bar to animate without preventing other application code from running.

21. API Summary

Function	Purpose
<code>begin()</code>	Initialise the LED bar
<code>setPins()</code>	Change DATA/CLOCK pins
<code>getDataPin()</code>	Read DATA pin
<code>getClockPin()</code>	Read CLOCK pin
<code>setLevel()</code>	Set bar level
<code>clear()</code>	Turn all LEDs off
<code>show()</code>	Send current frame
<code>setBrightness()</code>	Set one LED PWM
<code>setBrightnessPercent()</code>	Set one LED percentage
<code>getBrightness()</code>	Read one LED PWM
<code>getBrightnessPercent()</code>	Read one LED percentage
<code>setBrightnessArray()</code>	Set all LEDs by percentage
<code>getBrightnessArray()</code>	Read all LEDs by percentage
<code>setBrightnessArrayPWM()</code>	Set all LEDs by PWM
<code>getBrightnessArrayPWM()</code>	Read all LEDs by PWM
<code>setAllBrightness()</code>	Set all LEDs equally
<code>setGraduated()</code>	Enable/disable graduation
<code>getGraduated()</code>	Read graduation state

Function	Purpose
setGraduationMin()	Set graduation minimum
getGraduationMin()	Read graduation minimum
setGreenToRed()	Set logical direction
getGreenToRed()	Read logical direction
setTransition()	Enable/disable transitions
getTransition()	Read transition state
setTransitionSpeed()	Set transition speed
getTransitionSpeed()	Read transition speed
setTransitionTime()	Set transition time
getTransitionTime()	Read transition time
isTransitioning()	Check transition status
setFlashSpeed()	Set flash speed
getFlashSpeed()	Read flash speed
flashLED()	Flash one LED
isFlashing()	Check flash status
setEffectSpeed()	Set effect speed
getEffectSpeed()	Read effect speed
startEffect()	Start an effect
stopEffect()	Stop an effect
isEffectRunning()	Check effect status
setPulseRange()	Set Pulse/Breathe range
getPulseMinimum()	Read pulse minimum
getPulseMaximum()	Read pulse maximum
update()	Run non-blocking animation

22. Version History

V1.0

Basic PWM LED control.

V1.1

Graduated brightness.

V1.2

Configurable DATA/CLOCK pins and smooth transitions.

V1.3

Individual LED and array brightness control.

V1.4

Individual LED flashing.

V1.5

Independent flash overlay and improved flash/transition interaction.

V1.6

Moving Dot effect.

V1.7

Knight Rider effect.

V1.8

Pulse/Breathe effect with configurable minimum and maximum brightness.

End of API Reference

GroveLEDBarPWM V1.8.0